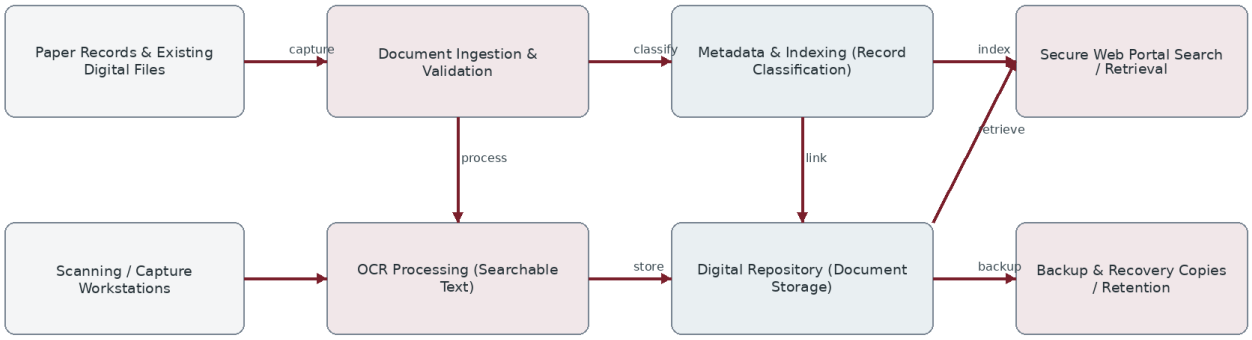
TECHNICAL PROPOSAL

PROVISION OF DIGITAL ARCHIVING SOLUTIONS

Technical Documentation & Proposed Solution Architecture

Prepared for: Soko & Co. Lawyers, Malawi
Prepared by: [Malawian-Based Bidder / Company Name]
Date: August 2026

Proposed Digital Archiving Solution — Logical Architecture



Cross-cutting controls: role-based access, authentication, audit logging, encryption in transit, controlled administration, and operational backups.

1. Executive Summary

This proposal presents a practical digital archiving solution for Soko & Co. Lawyers, designed around the firm's need to systematically capture, classify, store, search and retrieve physical and electronic records.

The approach prioritises dependable digitisation, structured metadata, searchable OCR where suitable, controlled access, auditability and recoverable backups. It is intentionally scoped to be achievable for a Malawi-based implementation and does not assume expensive proprietary ECM licensing or perfect OCR for every document.

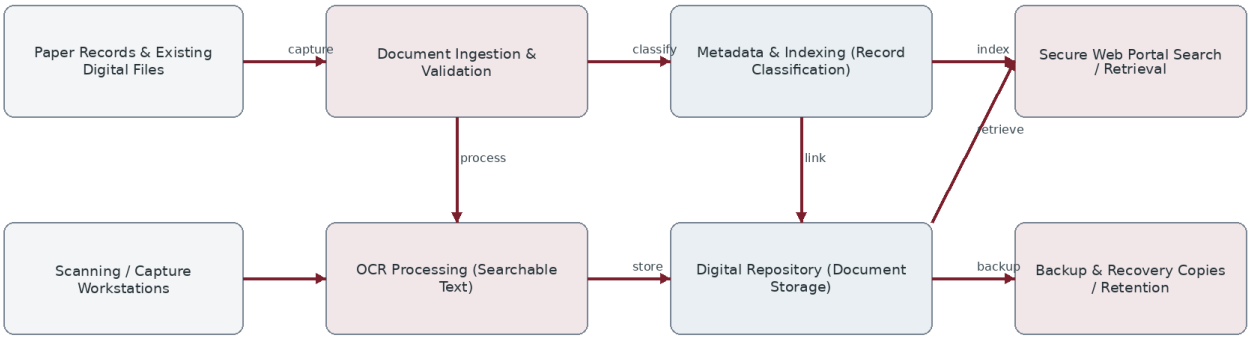
2. Understanding of the Requirement

The service covers digitisation and ongoing management of legal and administrative records. The objective is to reduce dependency on physical files while preserving the business value and traceability of source records.

3. Proposed Solution

The architecture separates capture, processing, storage, access and backup functions. This makes the solution easier to maintain and allows components to scale independently.

Proposed Digital Archiving Solution — Logical Architecture



Cross-cutting controls: role-based access, authentication, audit logging, encryption in transit, controlled administration, and operational backups.

4. Functional Components

Capture & Scanning: Digitise source records using suitable scanning equipment and controlled capture procedures.

Ingestion & Validation: Validate file format, reference information and basic completeness before repository storage.

OCR: Apply text extraction to suitable scans. OCR is an aid to discovery; the original scan remains the authoritative visual copy.

Metadata & Indexing: Store structured fields such as record reference, type, date, owner and confidentiality classification.

Repository: Store documents and metadata under controlled permissions.

Search & Retrieval: Search by metadata and, where OCR is available, searchable text.

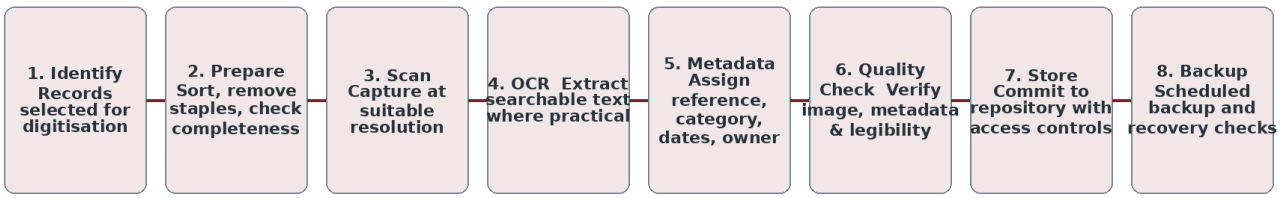
Audit & Administration: Manage users, roles, configuration and relevant audit events.

Backup & Recovery: Schedule backups and maintain a practical restore procedure.

5. Digitisation Workflow

The workflow is: identify → prepare → scan → OCR → metadata → quality check → store → backup. Failed scans, OCR exceptions or quality issues return to the relevant processing step rather than being silently archived.

Record Digitisation & Archival Workflow



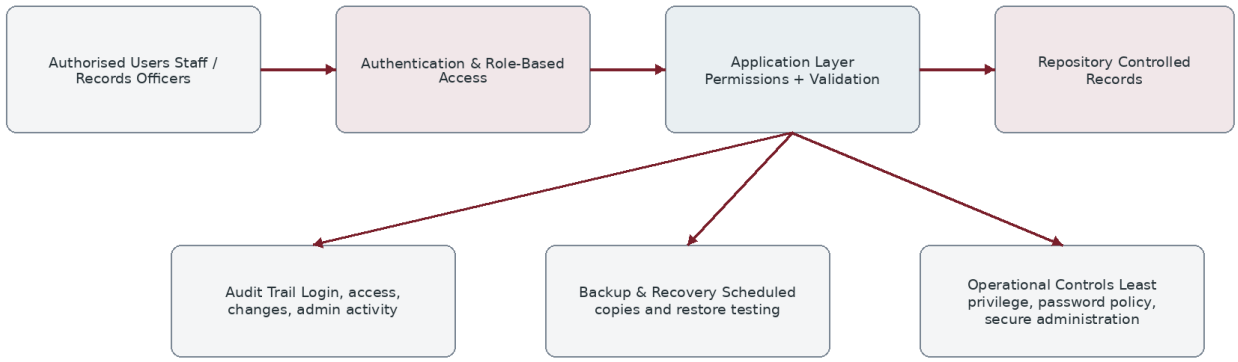
Exception path: failed scan/OCR/quality check → return to the relevant processing step rather than archiving an unverified record.

6. Security, Confidentiality & Access Control

Security is treated as a core requirement. Controls include authenticated users, role-based permissions, least privilege, controlled administration, audit logging, encryption in transit, protected backups and operational procedures for account and incident

management.

Security & Access Control Model



Security is designed as layered controls; exact retention periods, hosting location, encryption configuration and access roles are confirmed during implementation.

7. Infrastructure & Deployment

Final infrastructure will be sized after confirming record volume, average file size, scanning throughput, concurrent users, retention and hosting preferences. A modest initial deployment can be expanded when actual usage justifies additional capacity.

8. Implementation Methodology

Discovery & Assessment: confirm records, volumes, access roles and infrastructure.

Solution Design: finalise metadata, permissions, workflow, storage and backup.

Pilot: process a representative sample and validate quality.

Deployment: configure production environment and controls.

Digitisation: process agreed record batches with QA.

Training & Handover: train users and administrators and provide documentation.

Support & Optimisation: address issues and refine workflows.

9. Deliverables

Configured digital archiving application and repository; capture and indexing workflow; agreed metadata structure; OCR capability for suitable documents; authentication and role-based access; audit controls as agreed; backup/recovery procedure; pilot and production deployment; user/admin orientation; technical handover documentation.

10. Quality Assurance & Acceptance

Acceptance will use agreed functional and operational criteria rather than a blanket claim that every historical document will be perfectly digitised or OCR'd. Sample checks will assess image legibility, completeness, metadata correctness, search, access restrictions and retrieval.

11. Assumptions & Dependencies

Client access to records and nominated personnel; final server sizing after volume assessment; suitable scanning hardware; OCR accuracy dependent on document quality and language; bulk quantities and timelines confirmed after sampling; hosting and connectivity confirmed before production; third-party licences and proprietary integrations identified separately where applicable.

12. Scope Boundaries — What We Are Not Overpromising

Perfect OCR is not guaranteed for every historical record. Automatic legal interpretation or perfect AI classification is not assumed. Storage and scanning throughput are not unlimited. Backups do not by themselves constitute a complete disaster-recovery programme. Proprietary enterprise platforms are not prescribed before assessment.

13. Local Delivery & Support

As a Malawi-based implementation, the solution will favour practical local supportability, reasonable infrastructure requirements, maintainable components, documented administration and direct technical engagement. Specialist third-party equipment or services will be identified transparently.

14. Conclusion

The solution provides a controlled path from paper-heavy record keeping to a searchable digital archive without unnecessary complexity. Final infrastructure specifications, software components, schedule and commercial quantities should be confirmed following discovery and the pilot.

Note: This document is a technical proposal and should be read together with the final commercial proposal, agreed scope, implementation schedule and client-approved requirements.